

30-DAY FINANCE ROADMAP

4	30	100+	1
Weeks	Days	Concepts	Goal

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Why This Roadmap Exists

Most finance resources overwhelm you with theory and leave you with no idea what to actually do on Monday morning. This roadmap is different. Every day has a clear focus, concrete tasks, and a reason behind it. No

gatekeeping. No fluff. Just the exact path from knowing nothing about finance to being able to hold your own in a room full of analysts, bankers, and fund managers.

This is not about memorizing formulas. It is about building the mental model of how finance people think — so that whether the interview asks you about EBITDA, a stock pitch, or a recent deal, you have something real to say.

Four weeks. Four themes. Thirty days. Let's go.

Week 1	Build the Foundation — Language of Finance
Day 1-2 Financial Statements 101	-> Read a real P&L; (use any listed company's annual report) -> Understand Revenue, COGS, Gross Profit, EBITDA, PAT -> Learn what each line item means — not just the formula -> Practice: calculate GP margin and EBITDA margin from 2 companies -> Resource: Investopedia + any NSE-listed company's annual report
Day 3-4 Balance Sheet Deep Dive	-> Assets = Liabilities + Equity — internalize this identity -> Learn: Current vs Non-Current Assets, Debt structure, Equity components -> Understand Working Capital = CA - CL and why it matters -> Pick one FMCG and one IT company — compare their balance sheets -> Note: Where is cash sitting? What does debt look like?
Day 5-6 Cash Flow Statement	-> Understand CFO, CFI, CFF — and the difference between profit and cash -> Why a profitable company can still go bankrupt (cash conversion cycle) -> Learn Free Cash Flow = CFO - Capex -> Find a company with high PAT but negative CFO — understand why -> Resource: Screener.in for any Indian listed company
Day 7 Week 1 Review + Quiz Yourself	-> Without notes: define EBITDA, Working Capital, Free Cash Flow -> Pick any company — read its financials and narrate them to yourself -> What is the company's biggest asset? Biggest liability? Cash position? -> Write 5 lines summarizing the company's financial health -> This is your baseline — everything builds from here

PRO TIP Don't just read — write. After every concept, note it in your own words. That's how it sticks.

Week 2	Valuation — How Finance People Price the World
Day 8-9 Time Value of Money	-> PV, FV, Discounting, Compounding — master all four -> Discount Rate: why future cash flows are worth less today -> Calculate PV of Rs 1,00,000 received in 5 years at 10% discount rate -> Understand WACC: Weighted Average Cost of Capital (concept level) -> Resource: CFA Level 1 notes (free on AnalystPrep)

Day 10-11 DCF Valuation	-> Learn the 3-step DCF: Project FCF -> Discount -> Add Terminal Value -> Build a simple DCF in Excel for an Indian company (use Screener data) -> Understand Terminal Value = $FCF \times (1+g) / (WACC - g)$ -> Sensitivity table: what happens to value if WACC changes by 1%? -> Key insight: DCF is only as good as your assumptions
Day 12-13 Relative Valuation — Multiples	-> Learn P/E, EV/EBITDA, P/B, EV/Sales — when to use which -> Comparable Company Analysis (Comps): how to pick the right peers -> Find 5 Indian IT companies — compare their EV/EBITDA multiples -> Why does Infosys trade at a different multiple than a mid-cap IT firm? -> Practice: build a simple comps table in Excel
Day 14 Week 2 Review — Value Something	-> Pick any mid-cap Indian company — attempt a back-of-envelope valuation -> Use both DCF and a comps multiple — do they give similar answers? -> If not, which do you trust more and why? -> Write 3 sentences: bull case, bear case, base case for the stock -> Share your thinking with anyone — teaching forces clarity

PRO TIP Valuation is part science, part judgment. Learn the science first — judgment comes with reps.

Week 3	Markets, Products & Finance Roles
Day 15-16 Capital Markets 101	-> Primary vs Secondary market — IPO mechanics, book building -> Equity vs Debt markets — how companies raise money -> Learn: FII/DII flows, Nifty/Sensex composition, index rebalancing -> Understand how a bond is priced — inverse relationship with yield -> Follow one IPO news cycle end-to-end this week
Day 17-18 Buy Side vs Sell Side	-> Sell Side: Investment Banking (ECM, DCM, M&A;), Research, S&T; -> Buy Side: Mutual Funds, PMS, AIF, Hedge Funds, PE/VC -> Day in the life: what does a research analyst actually do? -> What does a PE associate do vs a mutual fund analyst? -> Resource: LinkedIn — find 5 people in each role and read their profiles
Day 19-20 Mergers & Acquisitions Basics	-> Why do companies acquire? Synergies, market share, capability -> Accretion vs Dilution — will the deal increase or decrease EPS? -> Learn: LBO concept — Private Equity buys a company using debt -> Read one real Indian M&A; deal (HDFC-HDFC Bank, Zomato-Blinkit, etc.) -> Understand deal structure: all-cash vs stock vs mixed
Day 21 Finance Products Deep Dive	-> Equity: shares, ETFs, mutual funds, PMS, AIF categories -> Debt: G-Secs, Corporate Bonds, NCDs, Fixed Deposits — risk spectrum -> Derivatives: what is a futures contract? What is an option? -> Alternative assets: REITs, InvITs, Gold, Commodities -> Build a mental map: risk vs return across all these products
PRO TIP	Finance is a big world. This week, map the terrain — understand what different roles actually do day-to-day.

Week 4	Interview-Ready — Application, Communication & Confidence
Day 22-23 Accounting Ratios That Interviewers Love	-> Profitability: ROE, ROA, ROCE, EBITDA margin, PAT margin -> Liquidity: Current Ratio, Quick Ratio, Cash Ratio -> Leverage: D/E ratio, Interest Coverage, Debt/EBITDA -> Efficiency: Asset Turnover, Inventory Days, Receivable Days -> Practice: calculate all ratios for 3 different Indian companies
Day 24-25 Stock Pitch Practice	-> Structure: Business -> Industry -> Financials -> Valuation -> Risks -> Prepare a 3-minute pitch on one Indian company you know well -> Bull case: why will this stock go up? Catalyst? -> Bear case: what can go wrong? Key risks? -> Record yourself. Listen back. Refine. Repeat.
Day 26-27 Finance Interview Question Bank	-> Walk me through a DCF — practice until it's under 2 minutes -> 'What is WACC and how do you calculate it?' — answer cold -> 'Give me a stock pitch' — 3 minutes, structured, confident -> 'Why investment banking / why asset management?' — authentic answer -> Guess Paper: tell me about a recent deal / market event and your view
Day 28-29 Build Your Finance Presence	-> LinkedIn: update headline, about section, add finance skills -> Follow 10 Indian finance professionals — engage with their content -> Read 1 equity research report (available free on NSE/BSE portals) -> Read Economic Times Markets or Mint for 20 min daily this week -> Start a finance journal: 1 concept, 1 company, 1 market move per day
Day 30 The Final Test — Simulate a Real Interview	-> Find a friend, mentor, or senior — do a mock finance interview -> Cover: Walk me through financials, do a stock pitch, answer 3 ratios -> If no one available: record a 10-minute video of yourself -> Reflect: What did you know cold? What needs more work? -> Celebrate: you have covered in 30 days what most take a semester to learn

PRO TIP

Finance interviews test how you think, not just what you know. Practice speaking your logic out loud every single day this week.

Your Resource Stack

Books	The Intelligent Investor (Graham) Financial Shenanigans (Schilit) Investment Banking (Rosenbaum & Pearl)
Indian Resources	Screener.in NSE/BSE Annual Reports SEBI circulars Mint / Economic Times Markets section
Free Courses	CFA Institute free resources AnalystPrep CFA L1 NSE Academy free modules Zerodha Varsity (free)
Follow on LinkedIn	Search: Indian buy-side analysts, CFA charterholders, IB associates at Big 4 / bulge brackets

Finance is not gatekept. It is just under-explained.

You just changed that for yourself.

Now go use it.